

Neorationalism

Also called *la tendenza*, neorationalism developed in the 1960s and 1970s, led by Italian architect and theoretician Aldo Rossi (1931–97), who advocated a reinvigoration of classicism in place of modernism, functionalism and postmodernism. Inspired by the paintings of Giorgio de Chirico (1888–1978), especially the dramatic perspectives, arcades and arches, squares and long streets, Rossi addressed many of these issues in his book *The Architecture of the City* (1966). From Italy, the movement progressed to Spain, France and Germany, focusing on the past and ignoring enthusiasms for new styles. It was the first truly Italian architectural movement since 1945 (when a large reconstruction programme was undertaken). Neorationalists included Álvaro Siza (b.1933), Mario Botta (b.1943), Henri Ciriani (b.1936) and Oswald Mathias Ungers (1926–2007). Drawing on historical knowledge, they designed imaginative buildings, aiming to reconnect the people through a built environment that would be more in step with contemporary needs.



Renovation of the Teatro Carlo Felice in Genoa, Rossi, 1991